

MAURYAN, BUDDHIST, JAIN AND ROCK-CUT HERITAGE

Continuous at-a-glance master rail: origin -> typology -> sites -> traps -> 2020 answer route

Core-first visual for Topic 02 only | built from the repaired learning session and workbook

THESIS -> monuments preserve patronage + ritual use + inscription + long reuse

READ THEM AS SOURCE CLUSTERS, NOT SITE LISTS

BEST EXAM MOVE -> named site + what it proves + one explicit limitation

01 | TWO TIMELINES

- Ancient development from Mauryan to Ellora
- Separate modern survey / UNESCO chronology
- Use chronology only to prevent anachronism
- Anchor dates: 3rd c. BCE, early 5th c. CE, 6th-12th c. CE

03 | BARABAR-NAGARJUNI

- Jehanabad, Bihar | 3rd c. BCE
- Ashoka + Dasharatha -> Ajivika dedications
- Polished granite interiors and wooden-form facade
- Oldest Indian rock-cut architecture

05 | SANCHI

- Mauryan core -> Sunga enlargement -> Satavahana toranas -> Gupta afterlife
- Best example of accretion in stone
- Pillar carries Schism Edict
- UNESCO 1989 is modern status, not ancient date

02 | MAURYAN FRAME

- Court art vs non-courtly is useful but porous
- Pillars = monolithic shaft + capital + abacus + inscription
- Sarnath / Vaishali / Sanchi show site variation
- Mauryan polish is evidence, not a total explanation

04 | STUPA LOGIC

- Pre-Buddhist memorial background
- Anda / vedika / pradakshina / harmika / chattra / torana
- Relic + movement + honour
- Parts matter only when linked to function

06 | BHARHUT + AMARAVATI

- Bharhut = aniconic, narrative, Shunga comparator
- Amaravati = lower Krishna Mahachaitya + Ayaka pillars

07 | CHAITYA / VIHARA

- Chaitya = apsidal worship hall with stupa focus
- Vihara = monastic residence with cells
- Bhaja / Karle / Nasik / Bedsa / Kondane / Pitalkhora
- Never reverse the two terms

09 | UDAYAGIRI + ELEPHANTA

- Udayagiri (Vidisha) = Chandragupta II + Varaha + Gupta inscriptions
- Elephanta = Gharapuri island + Sadashiva / Trimurti
- Brahmanical cave turn is a major phase
- Elephanta's exact patronage remains debated

11 | JAIN SPINE

- Udayagiri-Khandagiri + Hathigumpha
- Temple / colossus / hill-tirtha expansion
- Dilwara, Ranakpur, Shravanabelagola, Shatrunjaya
- Distinctive programme, often shared regional style

HIGH-RISK TRAPS -> do not reverse chaitya / vihara | do not romanticise Ellora | do not treat Hathigumpha as neutral | do not use UNESCO dates as ancient chronology
BEST CLOSE -> stone preserves architecture, image and inscription together, but it over-represents durable patronage rather than the whole of early Indian society.

06 | BHARHUT + AMARAVATI

- Bharhut = aniconic, narrative, Shunga comparator
- Amaravati = lower Krishna Mahachaitya + Ayaka pillars
- Limestone relief world and long excavation history
- Do not state Amaravati size without caution

08 | AJANTA

- Waghora gorge, Sahyadri hills, Maharashtra
- Two major phases: early + Vakataka-era later phase
- Chaityagrihas + viharas; unfinished caves show technique
- Painting caution: tempera / fresco secco is safer

10 | ELLORA

- 34 caves = 12 Buddhist + 17 Brahmanical + 5 Jain
- Sequence with overlap across 6th-12th centuries
- Cave 10 Visvakarma | Cave 16 Kailasha
- Baroda plate corroborates Ellapura / Kailasha fame

12 | 2020 GS-I ROUTE

- Define rock-cut as historical source
- Use Barabar + chaitya/vihara + Ajanta/Ellora + inscription
- State durable-patronage limitation explicitly
- Avoid cave-tour writing and false precision